

From One Megapixel To AI On Your Palm

RAVI KUNWAR | VP & CEO, HMD India and APAC



Ravi Kunwar has been in the mobility business for the entire 25 years this issue is celebrating – Nokia, Microsoft, and now HMD. His perspective carries the casual confidence of someone who watched the camera megapixel race start, peak, and stop mattering. On the next 25 years, he leans into possibility over prediction: e-SIMs, direct-to-mobile, satellite connectivity, and maybe – eventually – no device at all.

How has tech evolved over the past 25 years?

I'm someone which, at least in the mobility space, has seen that evolution in the past 25 years – at Nokia, Microsoft, and then HMD. And I very well remember that time when phones had a one-megapixel camera. That was an innovation. That was the Nokia 7610. Then it moved to 1.3, and now the numbers don't matter. So obviously, technology has evolved a lot.

I think there are two parts to what we are witnessing right now, in my opinion. One is the physical device manifestation of technology, and we have seen folds, curves, and multi-folds. And that will progress. But equally, I think

on the software side, that's where the leap has been much more, with AI now coming in. It's going to continue to evolve, because life, I believe, for any human will be centered around technology.

How is tech going to transform our lives in the next 25 years?

What physical form, shape, and manifestation that device takes is anyone's guess, but it will be around phones and smartphones. Whether they become multi-fold or they become imprinted on the palm of your hand, only time will tell. But then, obviously, AI will play a big role in terms of that

integration. Maybe on the palm of your hand, you won't need a device. From the device's side, the way I see it, it's multi-fold – obviously, a bigger screen which is still compact enough to be carried along with you, because a mobile phone or a smartphone continues to remain with you.

Another technology which is coming in which is without a SIM. So obviously, there are e-SIMs which are coming in, and then there is something where the phone is through satellite connectivity, and the data is there. As HMD, we are working very, very closely on D2M technology, which is direct-to-mobile, which doesn't need any SIM to play with. So those are all possibilities in the near future.

Any message to Digit on completing 25 years?

Absolutely. Continue doing the good work. I think 25 years is a lot of time in India. Technology is one space which always enlightens the consumers, and there is a lot to learn from that. And I think you guys have done a fantastic job in the last 25 years.

I would like to wish the entire Digit team all the best for the next 25 and more, and to continue engaging with your customers and giving them something more and more to learn. 

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